

GRIDALIGN

Coordination Opportunity Report

Georgia Power

Effingham County 500 kV

Distance between closest known points: 39.56 km

Dominion Energy South Carolina

Okatie - McIntosh 115kV Tie: Add Series Reactor

PROJECTS

- Project A: Effingham County 500 kV, a transmission line and substation project located in Effingham County, Georgia. The utility company is not specified in the provided data.
- Project B: Okatie - McIntosh 115kV Tie: Add Series Reactor, a substation construction and equipment addition project in Beaufort County, South Carolina. The utility company is not specified in the provided data.

WHY GRIDALIGN FLAGGED THIS PAIR

GridAlign flagged these projects based on geographic proximity. The closest known points between them are 39.56 km apart, placing them within the under 40 km distance category.

GEOGRAPHIC ANALYSIS

At a distance of 39.56 km across the Georgia and South Carolina state line, the two sites are too far apart to share right-of-way, local access routes, or physical laydown yards. However, this separation remains within a regional radius where utilities could potentially coordinate specialized equipment mobilization, regional contractor resources, or broad grid operations.

TIMELINE ANALYSIS

Project A has a planned start date of Fall 2027, with no completion date specified. Project B lists an estimated completion date of December 31, 2028, but does not provide a start date. Because schedule data is incomplete for both projects, timeline compatibility cannot be fully confirmed. If the construction schedules overlap during late 2027 or through 2028, a viable coordination window could potentially exist.

COORDINATION OPPORTUNITIES

- Contractor sharing: If construction schedules overlap, the utilities could potentially draw from the same regional pool of electrical or civil construction contractors.
- Specialized equipment mobilization: If specialized heavy transport vehicles, testing equipment, or high-capacity cranes are required for substation work, coordinating delivery sequences could potentially reduce overall transport demands.

- Outage planning: System operators may be able to align transmission outage schedules across the regional grid to prevent concurrent capacity bottlenecks.

POTENTIAL BENEFITS

- Potential decrease in mobilization expenses if shared contractors or specialized equipment can be sequenced between the two sites.
- Improved resource planning by notifying regional contractors of upcoming substation work well in advance.
- Reduced risk to regional transmission reliability through coordinated scheduling of line outages.

RISKS AND LIMITATIONS

- Incomplete schedule boundaries prevent confirmation of whether active on-site work will occur at the same time.
- The separation distance of nearly 40 km and the cross-state boundary rule out shared staging areas, joint permitting, and daily crew sharing.
- Distinct voltage levels (500 kV versus 115 kV) and different scopes may require different technical expertise, equipment types, and contractor qualifications.
- Operating utility companies are omitted from the supplied records.

FINAL ASSESSMENT

LOW

Coordination potential is evaluated as LOW because the projects sit near the outer 40 km limit, are located in different states, and involve different voltage classes. Meaningful opportunities are limited to indirect regional contractor awareness, potential mobilization sequencing, and high-level outage planning.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Project managers should share their preliminary 2027 and 2028 construction milestones to determine if active construction windows will coincide.